



Stained glass window of a Templar Knight in Warwickshire, England.



Guelph and Ghibelline forces join battle in Italy. These factions, based on the German Welf and Hohenstaufen dynasties, would come to dominate Italian politics.

“ IN THIS RELIGIOUS ORDER HAS FLOURISHED AND IS REVITALIZED THE ORDER OF KNIGHTHOOD. ”

From *The Primitive Rule of the Knights Templar*

In **Jerusalem**, in 1119, a group of knights, led by the French Hugues de Payens (c. 1070–1136), formed an order to **protect pilgrims** travelling along the dangerous road from Jaffa, on the coast, to the holy city. The new king of Jerusalem, **Baldwin II** (cousin of Baldwin I and his successor as count of Edessa), assigned them quarters in part of the **Temple Mount** compound, next to the site where the **Temple of Solomon** had once stood. Accordingly, they called themselves the Poor Fellow Soldiers of Christ and of the Temple of Solomon—also known as the **Knights Templar**.

Bologna University was the first in the western world. It was founded in 1119 (or possibly earlier, depending on the source). Institutions such as Bologna University were the incubators for the philosophical school of thought known as **Scholasticism** (see panel, right).

IN 1121, **MOHAMMAD IB-TUMART**, A **BERBER LEADER** from the Atlas Mountains, was hailed as the **al-Mahdi** (the Muslim messiah—see 874) and led his forces, known as the **Almohads**, in a **campaign of conquest** against Almoravid territories in Africa.

A synod at the German town of **Worms**, in 1122, presided by a papal legate drew up a concordat (agreement) ending the **Investiture Controversy**—although not the imperial–papal rivalry. A compromise was agreed along the lines already adopted between **Henry I of England** and **Anselm** (see 1107), under which the emperor would be involved in investiture but not control it. Essentially it was a **victory for the papacy**.

In 1123, **Frankish forces** from Jerusalem **defeated a Fatimid army** at Ibelin, while off the coast

SCHOLASTICISM



The school of thought known as Scholasticism—because it was taught by the scholastics, or school masters—developed as the dominant philosophy of learning in medieval Europe, hand in hand with the emergence of the universities. Scholasticism was an approach to learning that used a method of formal discussion and debating. It became the intellectual basis for medieval religious and philosophical dogma.

at Ascalon (Ashkelon), Venetian ships destroyed the Fatimid fleet. This marked the start of the dominance of **Italian maritime power** in the Mediterranean.

Emperor Henry V died in 1125 with no male heir, and an election was held to choose his successor. The closest heir was **Conrad of Swabia** (1122–90), of the house of **Hohenstaufen** (allied to the Salian dynasty and their antipapal policies), but the powerful archbishops of Mainz and Cologne angled for the election of a candidate more friendly to the Church. **Lothair of Saxony** (1075–1137), of the house of Welf, was chosen and became

Emperor Lothair II (III in some sources). Immediately he was plunged into a bitter **civil war** with the Hohenstaufens, and the two opposing sides became entrenched as propapal and proimperial factions known as the **Guelphs** and **Ghibellines** respectively. They would plague relations between and within the **city-states of northern Italy** into the 14th century—long after they had ceased to dominate German power politics—as they became associated with class struggles and **reactionary versus reforming parties**.

The work of **Aristotle** (384–322BCE) had survived in Byzantium and among the Arabs, but Western Europeans only had access to a translation by the

philosopher **Boethius** of one treatise on logic. This began to change in the early 12th century, as the conquest of Islamic areas such as **Toledo** and **Sicily** gave Christian scholars access to Arabic works. Increasing exposure to the works of Aristotle led medieval scholars to consider him the “**master of those who know**” and the chief authority on matters of reason.

In 1125, the French king **Louis VI** (1081–1137) successfully rallied French nobles to repel an **English–German invasion**. This proved to be a milestone in the French monarchy’s attempts to assert its authority, and thus in the emergence of **France as a nation-state**.



Aristotle in translation
A page from a translation of Aristotle’s *Nicomachean Ethics*, written on vellum—a writing material made from calf skin, which is more durable than papyrus or paper.

25 PERCENT

THE APPROXIMATE PROPORTION OF ARISTOTLE'S WORK SURVIVING TODAY

1116 Baldwin of Bourca becomes **Baldwin II**, king of Jerusalem

1118 **Alexius I Comnenus**, Byzantine emperor, institutes a form of feudalism in the empire

1119 **Knights Templar** founded in Jerusalem

1119 Foundation of **Bologna University**

1121 Almohads begin conquest of Almoravid territories

1122 Concordat of Worms ends **Investiture Controversy**

1123 **Baldwin II** captured by Danishmend Turks

1123 First Lateran Council: pope outlaws simony (selling of offices)

1123 **Fatimids** defeated at Ibelin and Ascalon

1123 Danishmend Turks take Aleppo from Seljuks and found **independent emirate**

1123 Founding of **St. Bartholomew's Fair** in London

1124 **Louis IV** repels English–German invasion

1124 **Hasan i-Sabbah** dies (b. c. 1050s)

1124 **Baldwin II** ransomed, then wins Tyre

1125 Death of Henry V triggers start of what will become known as the **Guelph–Ghibelline conflict**

1125 **Lothair** elected king of the Romans; renews expansion into Slavic territory

c. 1125 Death of **David III** of Georgia (b. 1073), who established it as independent state

1125 Jin occupy Beijing; **Khitai** Liao dynasty collapses